

- Burgers freeze really well. Make up the full batch (or double it), wrap well with plastic wrap and store in the freezer for up to 2 months.

If you can't handle the heat . . .

So, which signature dish should your kid choose?

Well, I'd suggest that you start off with one of Mum's recipes and then move on to 'Scott's Famous Pasta'. Or just get your kids to choose their own!

Whatever they choose, though, get them to make it theirs by coming up with their own name for it—like 'Pete's Passionate Pasta' or 'Fiona's Famous Fry-up'.

(Okay, so if your kids are young, you might be on dinner duties for a few more years. This step of the Barefoot Ten is really aimed at tweens and especially teens. That's not to say that little kids should be excluded, but maybe their meal is a breakfast rather than a sit-down meal.) Understand that you're creating family memories here. And not only will you get a night off the cooking, your kids will be able to fend for themselves when they move out!

The point of this chapter is not just to get a break from cooking now and then, or to get your kids to eat better meals, or to give them a dating advantage (though those things are important enough).

The real lesson is that being able to cook for yourself is a bloody smart financial decision compared to blowing the same amount on eating out (or ordering in) just once.

Think of it this way: when I was at uni, there was always *that* guy.

On a Tuesday—when Austudy hit—he'd be living like a king, eating steaks and downing beers.

Wednesday night, two-minute noodles.